

Week 02 Knowledge Check — TPM Academy

Week 2 Knowledge Check — Strategic Design & Metrics

A short retention check covering the week's core ideas: the metrics pyramid & vanity metrics, the North Star and its counter-metric, UX heuristics & design principles, AI-assisted research, and customer journey mapping. Answer each question, then check yourself against the key at the end. Aim for concepts, not trivia — every answer maps back to something we used in a lab.

Format: 12 questions (multiple choice + true/false). ~15 minutes. Individual or triad.

Questions

1. (MC) The Metrics Pyramid has a deliberate shape. Which set of counts, top to bottom, is correct?
 - A. Many North Stars, few KPIs, few operational signals
 - B. 1 North Star, 2–4 KPIs, 4–10 operational signals
 - C. 1 North Star, 10 KPIs, 2–3 operational signals
 - D. Equal numbers at every tier
2. (T/F) When a candidate operational signal can't be measured in production today, it's a failure that should be hidden until the data exists.
3. (MC) The North Star template requires exactly three parts. Which set?
 - A. Customer outcome, user segment, single number
 - B. Revenue, retention, NPS
 - C. Problem, solution, metric
 - D. Customer outcome, counter-metric, deadline
4. (MC) A counter-metric is best described as:
 - A. A backup North Star to use if the first one fails
 - B. A second metric that, if it moves the wrong way, signals you're winning the North Star for the wrong reasons
 - C. A competitor's metric you benchmark yourself against

- D. The KPI that sits directly below the North Star
- 5. (T/F)** A North Star that lands with leadership but needs translation before it means anything to the customer still qualifies as a defensible North Star.
- 6. (MC)** Beyond Nielsen’s 10 heuristics, Day 3 adds three TPM-specific lenses. Which set?
- A. Time-to-first-value, failure-mode dignity, power-user respect
 - B. Consistency, minimalism, error prevention
 - C. Color contrast, focus order, alt text
 - D. Severity, frequency, addressability
- 7. (T/F)** The TPM’s accessibility responsibility is to personally become the squad’s accessibility expert.
- 8. (MC)** Which request crosses the “bright line” — asking AI to do something it can’t do safely?
- A. “Structure these two product-tour transcripts into a comparison matrix”
 - B. “Identify 3 questions these materials don’t answer”
 - C. “What is ServiceTitan’s market share?”
 - D. “Tell me what’s missing relative to my own product”
- 9. (T/F)** When cross-validating an AI research summary, the AI’s own confidence rating (H/M/L) is a reliable signal of which themes you can trust.
- 10. (MC)** An AI summary cites “Ticket #4,” but no such ticket exists in your pack. Which summarization failure mode is this?
- A. Theme inflation
 - B. Citation invention
 - C. Premature confidence
 - D. Source bias
- 11. (MC)** A feature concept earns a place off the journey map only if it passes all three tests. Which set?
- A. Friction link, metric link, principle link
 - B. Cost, schedule, scope
 - C. Desirability, feasibility, viability
 - D. Severity, frequency, addressability
- 12. (MC)** On a journey map, a friction star on 5+ of the stages most likely means:
- A. The map is thorough and honest
 - B. You’re not discriminating — re-rank friction by severity
 - C. The product is beyond saving
 - D. You sanitized the journey and should re-listen to interviews
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Answer Key

- 1. B** — 1 North Star, 2–4 KPIs, 4–10 operational signals. Few at the top, many at the bottom. “A team that has 10 KPIs has 0 KPIs.”
- 2. False** — “We don’t measure that today” is not a failure, it’s a *finding* — an instrumentation gap. Surface it openly; it becomes a Week 4–5 conversation.
- 3. A** — Customer outcome / user segment / single number. Miss any blank and the team fights about which version of the NS they meant.
- 4. B** — A counter-metric is the guardrail: it catches when you move the North Star for the wrong reasons (e.g., time returned but trust broken). It’s the day’s most durable new tool.
- 5. False** — A defensible NS lands with the CEO *and* the customer without translation. If it only lands with one audience, it’s a KPI in disguise.
- 6. A** — Time-to-first-value, failure-mode dignity, power-user respect. (D, Severity × Frequency × Addressability, is Week 1’s pain model.)
- 7. False** — The job isn’t to be the ally expert; it’s to refuse to ship a feature that fails the 8-check floor — and to spot failures unsolicited.
- 8. C** — AI can summarize and structure source material you provide; it *cannot* tell you what competitors actually do. Market-fact questions return confident, fabricated answers.
- 9. False** — Don’t trust the AI’s confidence about its own output. Independent citation verification is the only reliable signal.
- 10. B** — Citation invention. Fix: verify every cited source exists and demote uncited claims. (Theme inflation lumps distinct complaints; source bias over-weights the loudest source.)
- 11. A** — Friction link, metric link, principle link. The recurring failure is features with no metric link — force the link or kill the feature.
- 12. B** — 5+ starred stages means you’re not discriminating; re-rank by severity. (2–3 stars is healthy; 0 stars means you sanitized the journey.)